This Is Bat Country — 60m drama | Created by Kerry Ann Burke

This Is Bat Country is a **neon-noir drama about modern vampires surviving inside the margins of off-strip, working class Las Vegas** while a series of killings threatens their exposure.

The tone is **noir first, black comedy second**. Humor comes from desperation and gallows survival instincts, never punchlines. And just because something is ridiculous doesn't mean it isn't dangerous. The comedy sharpens the horror rather than undercutting it.

CALEB TRYST, a Gen-X vampire, PI-wannabe, film buff, and general disaster, survives on the fringe of Vegas with nothing but guile, petty theft, and a *diegetic* noir narrator lodged in his skull, functioning as Caleb's tortured conscience, a source of dramatic irony, and the show's tonal signature.

Caleb can read people quickly and talk his way out of situations he has no business surviving, but is also impulsive and self-sabotaging, pushing away even the people trying to help him. Caleb avoids intimacy by turning everything into a case — including his own trauma. **He wants two things that don't coexist: to stay hidden and survive, and to learn who turned him into a vampire — and why.**

In the pilot, a serial killer, **JOSHUA,** is murdering young working-class Vegas women in a precise, escalating pattern. Caleb tries to capture him, but when he escapes, Caleb makes a catastrophic choice: he turns the killer's dying victim, **PATRICIA "PANTS" ANTSEL** into a vampire, not to save her life, but to preserve her witness testimony. Pants wakes furious, undead, and refusing to be reduced to a body in an evidence file. The only way she gets justice is by working with the vampire who made her this way.

The pilot frames the murders as a single killer case; the season reveals the machinery behind it. To stop further deaths and protect the vampire underground from exposure, they seek help from other vampires, including **ANGELINA**, Caleb's ex and a disciplined poker pro, and **STELIAN**, a "glittering" daylight-capable vampire who can read psychic residue left by the dead. In parallel, homicide detectives **RITTER & WILCOX** hunt the same killer through conventional police work, steadily closing in on Caleb and the vampire community without knowing vampires exist.

As the investigation deepens, Caleb realizes Joshua is not acting alone. Each lead pulls him closer to the truth that his own turning was not an accident, but part of a much older conflict — one that predates him, his turning, and Vegas itself. Each episode escalates the cost: the police investigation tightens, the vampire community fractures, and stopping the violence risks exposure while doing nothing guarantees more deaths.

Even as mysteries are solved, and the truth gets closer, the damage remains. **Dignity is optional. Survival isn't.**

Bat Country is an episodic, case-driven drama but with a serialized long-term arc. A neon-noir crime series that's a bit *Fargo* meets *The X-Files* in Las Vegas... with vampires. The true monster is the system that feeds on the vulnerable, and the most dangerous bloodsucker is the city itself.

Instead of focusing on redemption or damnation, this series explores *harm reduction, endurance, and community as forms of resistance against injustice.* It does not demand moral purity of its characters. It accepts moral compromise without romanticizing it.

Typically in this genre, vampires are metaphors for power or sex. Here, vampirism is being trapped in a body you don't understand, living under a sun that's a loaded gun. It's being bound by rules written without you, in a world that still expects you to obey. ***Bat Country* is a *queer survival metaphor* wearing fangs, blood, and satire, set against the neon machinery of late-capitalist survival.**

Kerry Ann Burke - kerry.ann.burke.screenwriter@gmail.com +353 89 218 0307